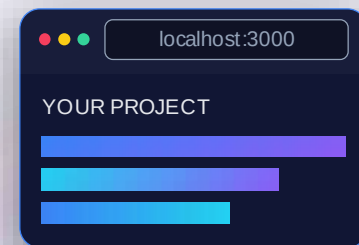


CODEFEST 2026

THE HACKATHON BEGINS



FROM LEARNING → BUILDING

"This morning you learned the tools. This afternoon, you use them."

C02 · THE BRIEF

THE CHALLENGE

You are not here to build random software. You are here to solve a real problem.

problem.md

THE PROBLEM

[The problem you're trying to solve or the goal of the app you want to build]

audience.md

WHO DOES IT AFFECT?

[Who the app is for or your target audience]

objective.md

YOUR OBJECTIVE

Build a practical solution that addresses the given problem, not a toy, not a demo of features, but a working answer to the brief above.

SOLVE THE PROBLEM. DO NOT JUST BUILD SOFTWARE.

C03 · TEAMS

FORM YOUR TEAM

5

STUDENTS
MAX PER TEAM

- Discuss ideas together before writing a single line of code
- Divide responsibilities so work happens in parallel
- Work collaboratively, pair, review, and merge often
- Roles may overlap; everyone ships

DEV 01 developer · role
DEVELOPMENT

DEV 02 developer · role
UI/UX · FRONTEND

DEV 03 developer · role
DOCUMENTATION · TESTING

These are suggestions, not required roles. Organize however your team works best.

C04 · PLAN FIRST

DON'T START WITH CODE

A smaller finished solution beats a huge unfinished system. Plan the path, then walk it. Fast.

MVP — MINIMUM VIABLE PRODUCT

The minimum set of features needed to demonstrate that your solution actually solves the problem. Cut everything else.

01 UNDERSTAND



02 BRAINSTORM



03 DEFINE MVP



04 PLAN



05 DESIGN



06 CHOOSE STACK



07 SET UP GITHUB



08 BUILD

C05 · WHAT YOU CAN BUILD

BUILD IT YOUR ANY TECH STACK IS ALLOWED



WEB APPLICATION



MOBILE APPLICATION



DESKTOP / STANDALONE



BROWSER EXTENSION



WEB3 / DAPP



AI-POWERED TOOL



API / INTEGRATION

OTHER
APPROPRIATE
SOFTWARE rules.md

// ALLOWED

- ▶ Boilerplates are allowed
- ▶ Libraries & frameworks are allowed
- ▶ External APIs are allowed
- ▶ AI models & tools are allowed

// PROHIBITED

- ✗ Major pre-existing codebases are prohibited
- ✗ Projects must be initiated during the hacking window

keep it original · keep it shippable

C06 · GITHUB IS PART OF THE
COMPEITION

YOUR REPOSITORY

PLAN →

BRANCH / WORK →

COMMIT →

PUSH →

REVIEW / PR →

MERGE

do.md

DO

- ✓ Meaningful commits
- ✓ Proper repository structure
- ✓ Branches where appropriate
- ✓ Pull requests for collaboration
- ✓ Proper .gitignore
- ✓ Maintain repository hygiene

never-push.md

NEVER PUSH

- ✗ .env
- ✗ API Keys
- ✗ Passwords
- ✗ Access Tokens
- ✗ Database Credentials
- ✗ Private Secrets

DO NOT COMMIT .ENV

One leaked token can disqualify a project. Use environment variables and never commit secrets.

CODE FREEZE

SEP 23, 2026

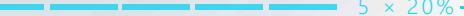
12:00 MIDNIGHT

All pushes after freeze are not evaluated.

C07 · JUDGING

5 CATEGORIES. EVERY CATEGORY MATTERS. EQUAL WEIGHT.

No category is more important than another. All five carry equal weight in the final score.

100% TOTAL  5 × 20%

01

FUNCTIONAL EXECUTION & USER EXPERIENCE

Live feature testing and reliability.

20%
WEIGHT 

02

UI, DESIGN & FRONTEND PRESENTATION

Visual quality, modern design, and responsiveness.

20%
WEIGHT 

03

CODE QUALITY & ARCHITECTURE

Clean structure, backend logic, scalability, and secure data management.

20%
WEIGHT 

04

DOCUMENTATION & VIDEO DEMONSTRATION

Documentation clarity, setup guides, and project demonstration.

20%
WEIGHT 

BEFORE YOU START

rules.checklist

- ✓ Maximum 5 students per team
- ✓ Original work created during the hacking window
- ✓ Maintain academic integrity at all times
- ✓ Respect participants, organizers, and judges
- ✓ Participants retain ownership of their projects
- ✓ CSO and ACLC may showcase submitted projects and demonstration videos
- ✓ GitHub Activity & Version Control is the primary tie-breaker in an exact score tie
- ✓ Video demonstration is required

?

OPEN ITEM · ORGANIZERS

Video Demonstration Duration

[CONFIRM FINAL VIDEO DURATION WITH
ORGANIZERS..]

Video duration must be at least 1 minute

CHAPTER 09 · LAUNCH

READY?

UNDERSTAND → PLAN → DESIGN → BUILD → COMMIT → TEST → DOCUMENT → SUBMIT

HACKING
STARTS
NOW.

Questions before we begin? LET'S BUILD.